

Cybersecurity for SME Employees

Module 2.4 – Secure Use of Wi-Fi and Remote Work

1 Objective

Teach employees how to stay secure while working remotely and using wireless networks, especially public or home Wi-Fi.

2 Introduction

Remote work has become the norm for many employees. However, working outside the office exposes data and systems to additional cybersecurity risks. This module focuses on how to stay secure while connected to Wi-Fi networks and while working from home or public spaces.

3 Dangers of Public Wi-Fi

- Public networks are often unencrypted and easy targets for attackers.
- Cybercriminals can intercept data (man-in-the-middle attacks).
- Rogue hotspots can trick users into connecting to fake networks.

4 Best Practices for Using Public Wi-Fi

- Avoid accessing sensitive company systems over public Wi-Fi.
- Use a Virtual Private Network (VPN) to encrypt all traffic.
- Disable auto-connect for unknown networks.
- Avoid entering passwords or performing financial transactions.

5 Using VPNs for Secure Connections

- A VPN creates a secure tunnel between your device and the company network.
- Use company-approved VPN software when working remotely.
- Keep VPN clients updated to ensure proper encryption protocols.

6 Securing Your Home Wi-Fi Network

- Change default router passwords and use strong Wi-Fi keys (WPA3 or WPA2).
- Disable WPS (Wi-Fi Protected Setup), which can be a vulnerability.
- Regularly update router firmware.
- Avoid sharing your home network with too many devices.

7 Device Security During Remote Work

- Use company-provided or approved devices when working remotely.
- Lock screens when stepping away.
- Enable full-disk encryption and antivirus.
- Do not let others (including family) use work devices.

8 Cloud Access and Collaboration Tools

- Use secure, company-approved tools like Microsoft 365 or Google Workspace.
- Avoid storing company files on personal cloud accounts.
- Be cautious about sharing documents — always check permissions.

9 Example Scenario

Saira works from a café and connects to the free Wi-Fi without a VPN. A cybercriminal on the same network intercepts her login credentials and uses them to access the company's internal dashboard. If Saira had used a VPN and secure browser practices, the breach could have been avoided.

10 Conclusion

Remote work brings flexibility, but also increased responsibility. By using VPNs, securing home networks, and being mindful on public Wi-Fi, employees can maintain strong security practices wherever they work. The next module will cover how to report suspicious incidents and red flags effectively.